MC

Title:
Space Cadets

Author:
Brandon Daley

© 2015 Brandon Daley

Published by
MUSHROOM CLOUD PRESS

a division of
BIG RODENT PRODUCTIONS
Orlando, FL

Permission for performance of this piece is granted for the purpose of performance in competition by middle school, high school, and undergraduate collegiate performers. Theatrical performance and all other kinds of public performance, whether broadcast, online, or on stage, are prohibited without prior written permission from Mushroom Cloud Press.

This script is authorized for competition only if the competitor or the competitor's representative, including but not limited to parent or educational entity, have purchased a copy of the script from Mushroom Cloud Press or an authorized retailer. The script must be presented with the cover sheet bearing the ISBN. Additional requirements for performance may be made by tournament and league rules.

League officials: please contact Mushroom Cloud Press to validate script purchase.

Inquiries, sales, and service with a smile:
MushroomCloudPress.com
"Winning Rounds Since 2000"

Space Cadets

(A space ship flies through space dodging meteors)

Narrator: It is the year 2328. After years of improper trash disposal, overpopulation, deforestation, rising CO2 levels, and other general abuse, Planet Earth has become uninhabitable. We now join Command Leader Sarah Bendlestien and her trusty Co-Pilot Becky on their search for a new home, currently cascading the meteors, black holes and other intergalactic terrors of Sector 9A14 on their journey to happiness.

Sarah: Ugh…Sector 9A14 is soooo boring.

Becky: Maybe we should get high.

Sarah: Becky! You are the worst co-pilot in the world. Don't get high until we find a place to refuel the ship's gooby perker supply at least. I swear, you would have no redeemable qualities if you weren't pretty.

Becky: Awwww - Sarah! You think I'm pretty?!

(Becky takes a big bong rip).

Sarah: Oh my god - I have to do everything around here.

(The ship's video phone rings.)

Becky: I'll get it!

Sarah: No just let it ring. It's probably a space telemarketer.

Becky: What if its other humans?

Sarah: There's no way that-

(Becky pushes a button to answer it).

Becky: Command Leader Sarah Bendlestien and her trusty Space Cadet Becky here. May I ask whose calling?

(Command Leader John H. Kelleher and his co-pilot Scott Pockets)

John: Hello! Hello - oh thank god…please - we are in desperate need of help. My name is Command Leader John H. Kelleher and this is my co-pilot Scott Pockets.

Scott: Hey there ladies!

John: We are currently running extremely low on gooby perker supply. Is there anyway we can mount our ship to yours until we get to a safe refueling location?

Becky: Oh my goodness! It's been so long since we've talked to other humans! Definitely we'll extend out the gasoline dock-

Sarah: Actually - boys, I hate to break it to you. Space Cadet Becky is a little high right now and has forgotten that we're running low on gooby perkers ourselves. I don't think we have enough to spare.

Becky: Oh come on Sarah - don't be like that!

(Sarah holds the microphone so the other ship can't hear her).

Sarah: Look, Becky, we have no idea who these dudes are. Gooby perkers aside, are you going to indulge every intergalactic traveller we come across asking to mount us?

Becky: Well, yes.

Sarah: You have no idea about the unwanted terrors this galaxy can bring. For all we know, these two could be space burglars or serial killers or some kind of improv group or something. And besides they're not even that cute.

Becky: The co-pilot's kind of cute.

(Sarah starts to take her hand off the mic and returns her focus to piloting)

Sarah: Please Becky, you can't be serious, he's got one of those tiny ponytails on the top of his head. If you're rocking one of those then we all know you've got some serious confidence issues on your hands.

John: We can hear you now. You took your hand of the mic.

Sarah: Yeah I know, you needed to hear that.

Scott: Oh okay sorry thanks yeah the ponytails just something new I've been trying out but yeah okay I understand if it doesn't work for you…

Becky: Why do you have to be so mean all the time Sarah!? We've been traveling for months and these are the first other humans we've come in contact

with! Can't you just be a little grateful for this?

Sarah: Becky, you know being grateful's not my game. Besides, what you say doesn't even matter. I'm the captain of this ship and what I say goes-

Becky: Docking station -

(Becky pushes a button on the dashboard)

Becky: Engaged!

Sarah: God, I always forget how easy it is to engage that docking station.

Becky: Okay gentlemen! I've just extended out the port and we're ready for you to mount us!

John: Thank you so much ladies. We appreciate you finding the kindness in your hearts to ration a few of your final gooby perkers to some random space strangers.

Scott: Yeah, thank you so so much. It's so awesome you guys could do that. You guys, are like the coolest.

Sarah: Keep it in your pants Bronytail. We're only giving you enough perkers to get you to the nearest place to fill-up. In the meantime, no funny business when you're aboard our ship. You got that?

Becky: Yeah, like please make sure to put the seat down! We get that the gravity makes it float up sometimes but still, we're trying to keep a tight operation going around here.

(Becky takes another bong rip).

John: Rodger that, we'll be aboard in just one second. This is Command Leader John H. Kelleher and my co-pilot Scott Pockets saying over and out, and god bless.

Scott: Yeah bye. See you. Gosh you guys are like, so, helpful. I really, wow, yeah, its just like so cool-

(Sarah cuts the feed off).

Sarah: You're a piece of work, you know that?

Becky: I'm excited!

Sarah: You better pray they don't turn out to be an improv group.

Becky: You always assume the worst! The universe can be a dark place if that's how you always choose to see it.

Sarah: The universe *is* a dark place Becky! I've been piloting a long time. I've seen how dark this universe can get.

Becky: Well, I'm sure there's been a lot of light that you're overlooking as well.

Sarah: Looks like your new friends just docked in your station.

Becky: Oh I didn't even notice. Maybe I'll make us up some Tang.

Sarah: Huh - that's strange. They aren't accessing the gooby perker port.

Becky: I wonder if they're having troubles with it.

Sarah: Or maybe…they aren't here for our gooby perkers-

(Suddenly, the doors to the ship's cockpit burst open. Command Leader John H. Kelleher and co-pilot Scott Pockets burst in wielding laser guns).

John: Alright! Nobody say a word.

Becky: Oh my gosh! He's got a gun!

John: What'd I just say!?

Becky: What did you just say?

John: Yeah-

Becky: You just said what'd I just say.

John: No before that!

Becky: Oh I don't really remember.

John: You don't remember?

Becky: Yeah my memory's not that great.

John: I said nobody say a word.

Becky: Well, we've both been breaking your rule then!

John: No, just stop talking or I'm going to shoot you.

Becky: When am I supposed to stop? Like right now?

John: Yes.

Becky: Okay, sorry, just clarifying, not saying anything more after this sentence that I'm finishing right now after these words I'm saying are done being said…

(A moment while everyone waits to see if she's done talking)

Becky: You guys don't do improv do you?

John: SILENCE!

Scott: I do a little improv actually.

Sarah: I bet you do, don't you Bronytail.

(Scott points to his hair).

Scott: I took it out okay! See? Do you see the ponytail anymore? Dang, I was, just trying it out. I don't always keep it like that. You don't have to make fun of me so much.

Sarah: Folding like the wet self-conscious napkin that you are. Look, I think it's safe to assume you aren't here for our gooby perkers so why don't you take what you want and get off of our ship?

John: Truth is its not that easy Command Leader. I'm afraid we're not actually human. We're shape shifters from Sector Quad5P!

Scott: That's right, and what we're here for is far harder to part with than a few gooby perkers.

Becky: Oh no! Not the bong!

John: No not the- jesus, your brains! We need your brains. Okay? Secret's out. We're harvesting the brains of various species so we can interpret scans of the

stored information in order to more adequately shape shift into a wider variety of species, all so we can do some intergalactic thing or something, I don't know. You wouldn't understand, its kind of hard to understand. Long story short, we're going to have to cut your heads open.

Becky: But we get to keep the bong?

Sarah: You can keep the bong Becky. They're shapeshifters—they don't have lungs.

Becky: Ugh - that's rough.

(she rips the bong)

John: Now we can do this the easy way or the hard way.

(John and Scott both pull out weapons for scalping the girls)

Sarah: Okay well, although I'm flattered that two men are finally interested in us for our brains and not our incredible bodies, I have to politely decline your request and ask you both to leave my ship before things get uglier then Bronytail's subconscious.

Scott: Oh come on!

John: Well, sounds like we'll be doing this the hard way then.

(John and Scott put away their weapons and begin to slowly shape shift and change, their bodies eventually morphing together to form a two headed four-legged, four-armed slimy space alien).

Becky: Oh my god! A space monster!

John: That's right - we've shapeshifted into a collective space monster - modeled after the deadly and venomous Gragoons of Sector 18Q. Unlike humans, they can withstand gunshots and blades and lasers and any other form of defense that you may have access to.

Scott: That's right, you had one opportunity to kill us and you missed it!

John: And don't let the fact that we are now one fool you. This one body still houses two independent minds.

Scott: Yes - its double the intelligence all wrapped up in one of the most

dangerous creatures in the universe!

(A high Becky has wandered off in thought - she suddenly notices the alien again).

Becky: Oh my god! A space monster!

Sarah: Wait a minute - let me get this straight. If you can shape shift into any thing imaginable, then why did you guys pick such unattractive human alter egos?

Scott: Hey! Quit picking on us so much! We worked really hard on those alter egos!

John: Don't listen to her anymore Scott! She's manipulative and conniving. I've come across her type before - they get anything they want from you merely by playing with your emotions using precisely executed word choice, tone of voice and good looks.

Scott: I didn't know such a manipulative specimen existed in this galaxy.

Sarah: You've obviously never had a girlfriend before then.

Scott: I've had lots of girlfriends okay!

Sarah: You've had a lot of girlfriends just like Becky has had a lot of good ideas.

Becky: I'll be your girlfriend!

Scott: Just stop making - wait, you would? Wow that's…haha. Jeesh.

Becky: Yeah, I thought you were kind of cute before you morphed into this whole weird space alien thing that can't be killed.

(Sarah realizes Becky may actually be having a good idea even though Becky herself doesn't realize it. She starts to play along).

Sarah: Oh come on Becky - why would you pick Co-Pilot Scott "Bronytail" Pockets when you could have the man in charge? The one and only Command Leader John H. Kelleher - older, wiser, years of experience.

John: Oh, haha, well - my human persona isn't that old, you know. I like to think he does have a whole George Clooney type of vibe thing going on and I appreciate that you recognize that.

Scott: Yeah, I was going for a younger Keanu Reeves type of thing, but I totally respect going more towards Clooney.

John: Thank you - and you know I don't disrespect Keanu one bit. 47 Ronin is a personal favorite of mine.

Sarah: Wow you guys have quite the knowledge of human celebrities for being space-traveling shape shifters from an alternate galaxy.

Becky: Yeah! That is kind of weird…

Sarah: Say - before you do this whole harvesting thing, why not take a quick detour back to your human bodies for a little bit? Eh? What do you say? Maybe we can have a little fun before you extract our brains?

Becky: Yeah maybe we can kiss and stuff!

(Becky starts to take a rip of her bong)

Scott: Haha, oh gosh - well, I mean - it's a dying girl's wish John. Maybe we could do a little kissing, don't you think John?

John: Haha, oh well, I suppose I couldn't reject a dying girl's last wish of a couple kisses. Plus it would be fun taking those human alter egos for a bit of a test drive, if you know what I mean…haha.

Scott: Oh, well, I think I do know what you mean, haha, since we objectively clarified what was meant right before you asked me if you know what I mean.

John: Yes, oh yes sorry, please excuse my silly need for the unnecessary chit chat ladies. It's just that, I get a little nervous as I've never kissed a human before.

Scott: Well, we had our human alter egos kiss that one time didn't we-?

John: OHH Scott, I think we needn't bore these beautiful vixens with exhausting anecdotes like that one. Haha, don't listen to him ladies.

Scott: Oh, yeah don't listen to me, we didn't kiss each other with our human alter egos.

John: Stop saying that!

Scott: What?! I said we didn't do that! Why would I say we didn't do that if we did do that. Hahahaha, huh ladies? Does that make any sense to you? Why would I say we didn't kiss if we actually did kiss?

John: Jesus! Just, stop talking, you are so embarrassing - okay, just a second ladies! I'm going to just separate myself from my over-excited partner here-

Scott: Partner being a totally platonic and non-experimental term mind you-

John: And we'll be right back into our human forms in just a jiffy. Just…one…second-

(John and Scott begin to separate themselves and shape shift back into their normal forms. Becky and Sarah look bored waiting and watching all of their mundane back and forth. After a moment of transformation, John and Scott are now back to their human personas).

John: Perfect! Good as new! Haha…

Scott: Yes, yes, now, Becky is it? If you wouldn't mind just coming over here a little bit closer and we can get started - now, do you want the ponytail in or out, I wasn't 100 percent clear on *your* stance on the whole thing because your command leader GAH-

(Scott suddenly takes a shot to the chest. He falls to the ground).

Scott: I've been shot!

John: Hey, what the- ULGH!

(Shortly after, John is shot also. He crumbles to his knees).

John: Oh my god I've also been shot.

(Sarah holds up a space pistol. Becky takes a rip out of a bong. She glances up to notice that the two have been shot).

Sarah: Got ya!

Becky: My boyfriend!

(Sarah grabs the bong out of Becky's hand and uses it to beat the remaining life out of John and Scott).

Becky: MY BONGGGG!!!!

(After a long time of beating, Sarah drops the bong and lets her head drop. She picks up John's hand and lets go of it to make sure he's dead. Becky crouches down next to her weeping).

Becky: My beautiful bong…

Sarah: I'm so sorry Becky - it was for a good cause…

Becky: Rippy Bongstockings never did anything to hurt you!

Sarah: Aside from decreasing your work efficiency and critical thinking capacity by at least forty percent, you're right, it never did anything to hurt me. But we sacrificed it for the good of the humanity Becky! And our brains. Mainly our brains.

Becky: Forget our brains Sarah! What's the point of a brain if you can't mess it up with recreational drug abuse and what's the point of a life if you're only boyfriend in the entire universe is a dead shape shifter and I just don't know how much longer I can continue onwards on these messed up space adventures!

Sarah: I know Becky. Unfortunately, this life chose us. And even if you don't have a shapeshifting boyfriend, you always got me.

Becky: Yeah, I guess I so…

Sarah: I love you Becky.

Becky: I love you too Sarah.

Narrator: And so Becky and Sarah continued their travels onwards, cascading through the unknown terrors and obstacles frequently found in Sector 9A14. All that they had in this entire universe was each other, but no matter how close they got during these travels through the empty abysses of space and time, neither could ultimately shake the feeling of being alone. So they beat on, boats against the current, borne back ceaselessly into the gooby perkers.